

MONEY MATTERS

2026 – 2027 · COURSE SYLLABUS



YEARLONG · ROOM 2115 · BUSINESS, MARKETING & FINANCE · DECA

INSTRUCTOR

Tony Morales

EMAIL

tony.morales@leanderisd.org

CLASS WEBSITE

tonymorales5.wixsite.com/comp-sci

HOW TO READ THIS

Every section below is tagged with who sets the rule: the State of Texas, Leander ISD, Vista Ridge, or this classroom.

WELCOME

SET BY
MR. MORALES

Welcome to The Ridge. Money Matters is the class where the math finally has your name on it. Every decision we study, what to do with a paycheck, how debt actually works, when to start investing, is one you will make for real, probably sooner than you think.

Everything you need to know about how this class runs is in here. Keep it somewhere you can find it. If you or your family ever need anything, reach out. Go Rangers.

MR. MORALES'S PRO TIP

Finish your work during class. Then you walk out with nothing hanging over you: no homework, full credit on the assignment, and you come back ready for the next topic.

COURSE OVERVIEW

SET BY
TEXAS TEKS

Money Matters investigates money management from a personal financial perspective. You will apply critical-thinking skills to analyze financial options against current and projected economic conditions.

You will build the knowledge and skills to set and reach short-term and long-term financial goals through investing, debt management, tax planning, asset allocation, risk management, retirement planning, and estate planning.

WHAT WE COVER

Decision making · Money · Banking · Income · Saving · Investing · Career planning · Insurance · Budgeting · Consumer skills · Economics and private enterprise · Business types and government

WHAT TO BRING

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

- › A charged laptop, every day. Bring your charger too.
- › Wired headphones. You will need them for curriculum videos. Only wired headphones may be plugged into laptops and Chromebooks, and only for classwork.
- › A way to take notes. Bring something to write with and something to write on.

Laptop details are in the [mLISD Empowered Learning 1:1 initiative](#). Need help getting supplies? Contact me. No student goes without.

STUDENT
EXPECTATIONS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

These are simple, and every one of them transfers to whatever workplace you end up in.

- › **Be on time.** Use your class time well.
- › **Be prepared.** Come with a charged laptop, your charger, and any supplies assigned.
- › **Participate.** Listen during lectures, join the activities, ask real questions.
- › **Manage your time.** Complete and submit every assignment by its due date.
- › **Respect others.** Treat classmates, teachers, staff, and substitutes with kindness. Listen when someone else is speaking. Bullying and harassment are not tolerated.
- › **Watch your language.** Swearing, insults, and derogatory comments have no place here.
- › **Respect property.** Take care of the furniture, equipment, and materials. Do not deface or damage anything, and clean up after yourself and your classmates.
- › **Own your learning, earn your grade.** Try your best, learn from your mistakes, and ask for help when you need it.

PHONES & DEVICES

SET BY
STATE OF TEXAS

Under **House Bill 1481**, phones and other personal electronic devices, including smart watches, tablets, gaming devices, and headphones or earbuds with cellular connectivity, may not be used on campus between 8:05 AM and 3:35 PM. That includes restrooms, hallways, and lunch. Make electronic MINGA hall passes on a computer.

Devices stay **away and unseen** in your backpack or bag. Not on your person, not in a pocket, not in a waistband. If you do not carry a bag, leave your device in the AP office.

- FIRST INCIDENT**.....Warning and contact home
- SECOND INCIDENT**.....Referral to your AP

Repeated violations can mean a parent or guardian picks the device up from VRHS, and you may lose the privilege of bringing one to school. Continued violations follow the Vista Ridge and Leander ISD Student Code of Conduct. Remember that this is state law.

IF EXPECTATIONS
ARE NOT MET

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

- FIRST**.....Verbal warning
- SECOND**.....Private conversation with me
- THIRD**.....Parent or guardian contact
- FOURTH**.....Classroom consequence
- FIFTH**.....Office referral

TARDY POLICY

SET BY
VISTA RIDGE HS

Arrive after the tardy bell and you are marked tardy. Arrive **10 or more minutes late** and you are marked absent. Leave class for more than 10 minutes and you are marked absent.

If there are extenuating circumstances, especially for 1st and 5th period, go to the front office with an excuse. Emergencies and medical situations go there too. The office decides whether to change your attendance status.

HOW GRADES WORK

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

Grades go into three categories. Mastery shows what you can do. Daily assignments show the routine work that gets you there. Participation shows that you engaged.

MASTERY	50%
DAILY ASSIGNMENTS	35%
PARTICIPATION	15%

Participation covers content summaries, exit tickets, warm-ups, and the employability skills in the TEKS.

An assignment you have not turned in is marked Missing and averages in as a zero until you submit it.

LATE WORK & REDOS

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

Work is due during your scheduled class period. Anything turned in after that is late and can earn a **maximum score of 80**.

Late work can still be redone. You may need to finish steps I assign first, such as attending tutorials or making corrections. A redo replaces your score with up to an 80, and if you already scored above an 80 that grade stands. You have a one-week window.

Turn in all work and final redos at least one week before grades are due at the end of the grading period.

MISSED WORK & ABSENCES

SET BY
LEANDER ISD

If you are absent, check Google Classroom for missed assignments, notes, and slide decks, then check in with me the day you return. For an excused absence you get one day for each class meeting you missed to make up the work, and anything already assigned and due on the day you were absent is due at the next class meeting. For example, if you are out on an A day, a B day, and an A day, you have two days to make up A day work and one day to make up B day work.

ACADEMIC HONESTY

SET BY
VISTA RIDGE HS

Academic dishonesty is not tolerated. If you cheat or help someone else cheat, including sharing completed work through Google Drive, the offense is documented, your parent or guardian is contacted, and a referral goes to the AP office for your record.

- › **First offense on daily work.** Automatic zero.
- › **First offense on an exam or project.** Redo the work for a maximum score of 50, or accept the zero.
- › **Habitual offenses.** Zero regardless of assignment weight, and loss of all exemption privileges.

Plagiarism is copying from any source, including AI, websites, books, and classmates, or presenting ideas that did not originate with you. Sources are a good thing when you credit them properly.

TUTORIALS & HELP

SET BY
THIS CLASSROOM

DECA

SET BY
VISTA RIDGE HS

TUESDAY THROUGH THURSDAY · A DAYS AND B DAYS
BEFORE SCHOOL 7:30 – 8:00 AM · Room 2115
AFTER SCHOOL 3:35 – 4:05 PM · Room 2115
RANGER TIME

I will have open tutorial times on movement days for Ranger Time.

DECA prepares emerging leaders and entrepreneurs in marketing, finance, hospitality, and management. Members get classroom extension of the curriculum, competition at the district, state, and national levels, chapter service projects, and leadership opportunities on and off campus.

I am one of the DECA advisors at Vista Ridge. Mr. Martinez is the lead advisor, and either of us can get you started.

To join for 2026-2027 you must be enrolled in a Business, Marketing, Finance, or Entrepreneurship class. Money Matters qualifies. Submit parental consent forms and pay dues in full to be considered for a competition slot.

Competing members take part in Decision Day, presenting a proposal or executive summary to a panel of judges and scored on a DECA rubric. The competitive team is capped at 100 members, competing individually or in teams of up to three.

COMPETITION SCHEDULE
DISTRICT 5 CDC Round Rock, TX · Dec 7–8, 2026
STATE CDC Houston, TX · Feb 25–27, 2027
INTERNATIONAL CDC Anaheim, CA · Apr 17–20, 2027

CULTURE OF
SUCCESS

SET BY
VISTA RIDGE HS

Student agency. You believe in yourself and act with intention: building relationships, pushing through obstacles, and putting your academic, social, emotional, and professional skills to work to reach your potential.

Relational capacity. The connection between people that grows over time when interactions are built on respect, trust, and authenticity.

Both come from AVID, and both are how this room runs.

LISD CTE NON-DISCRIMINATION STATEMENT

Leander ISD does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, or disability in its programs or activities and provides equal access to the Boy Scouts and other designated youth groups. The following person has been designated to handle inquiries regarding the nondiscrimination policies: Bryan Miller, Title IX Coordinator; 204 W. South Street Leander, TX 78646; Bryan.Miller@Leanderisd.org; (512) 570-0000.

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